



USER GUIDE

Online Counselling

Counselling at your doorstep

Complete Platform Walkthrough — Clients & Counsellors

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A step-by-step guide to creating an account,
finding a counsellor, booking appointments,
and using secure sessions and community
Q&A.

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Welcome to Online Counselling

What the platform is, and who it's for

Online Counselling is a mobile app that connects people who need someone to talk to (**Clients**) with qualified, licensed professionals (**Counsellors**) — psychologists, marriage counsellors, career counsellors, family and child counsellors, addiction and grief counsellors, and more — all from your phone.

The platform brings together four core experiences:

- **Discovery** — search and browse counsellors by specialty, region and rating.
- **Sessions** — a private one-on-one chat with a counsellor, supporting text, photos and voice notes.
- **Appointments** — book, accept, reschedule or cancel a scheduled meeting with a counsellor.
- **Community** — ask questions anonymously or openly and get responses from the wider community and counsellors.

WHO IS THIS GUIDE FOR?

This guide covers both account types. Steps that only apply to Clients or only to Counsellors are clearly marked with a coloured chip, like Client only.

Client vs. Counsellor Accounts

Every account on the platform is one of two types

When you sign up, you choose whether you are joining as a **Client** (someone seeking counselling) or a **Counsellor** (a professional offering it). This choice determines what you see in the app.

Client

- Sees the **Home** tab to search and browse counsellors
- Can start chat sessions and book appointments
- Can post and comment in the Community
- Provides: date of birth, education level, marital status, employment status

Counsellor

- No Home/search tab — the app opens straight to Community
- Receives session requests and appointment bookings from clients
- Accepts or ends sessions and appointments
- Provides: area of specialisation and a licence/certificate photo for verification

GOOD TO KNOW

Your account type is fixed at sign-up and is also selected again at login, so make sure you pick the same type you registered with.

3 Creating an Account

A 3-step sign-up: Personal Info → Contact & Address → Other Info

From the welcome screen, tap **Sign Up**. Registration is split into three short steps; you can go **Back** at any point to correct earlier answers.

Step 1 — Personal Information

- 1 Select your **User Type**: Counsellor or Client.
- 2 Enter your **email address** and choose a **password**.
- 3 Enter your **full name** and **gender**.
- 4 Client only Enter your **date of birth** (you must be 18 or older).
- 5 Add a short line **about you**.
- 6 Tap **Continue**.

Step 2 — Contact & Address Information

- 1 Enter a valid 10-digit **phone number**.
- 2 Enter your **address**.
- 3 Choose your **region** from the list (all 16 regions of Ghana are supported).
- 4 Enter your **city**, then tap **Continue**.

Step 3 — Other Information

- 1 Tap the profile photo box to add a clear, well-lit picture from your **camera** or **gallery**.
- 2 Client only Select your **education level**, **marital status** and **employment status**.
- 3 Select your **religion**.
- 4 Counsellor only Select your **counsellor type / specialisation** (e.g. Psychologist, Marriage Counsellor, Family Counsellor) and upload a photo of your **licence or certificate** — this is required and cannot be skipped.
- 5 Tap **Create Account**.

COUNSELLORS — VERIFICATION

A licence/certificate photo is mandatory for counsellor accounts. Without it, the app will block account creation with an "Incomplete Data" message.

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Logging In & Resetting Your Password

Getting back into your account

Logging in

- 1 Open the app and tap **Login** from the welcome screen (or the "Login" link on the Sign Up screen).
- 2 Enter your **email** and **password**.
- 3 Select your **User Type** (Counsellor or Client) — this must match how you registered.
- 4 Tap **Login**.

Forgot your password?

- 1 On the Login screen, tap **Forgot Password?**.
- 2 Enter the email address associated with your account.
- 3 Follow the instructions sent to your email to reset your password, then return to the app and log in.

STAYING SIGNED IN

Once logged in, the app remembers you and takes you straight to the main screen the next time you open it, until you tap

LOGOUT

from your profile menu.

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Finding Your Way Around the App

The bottom navigation bar

Once logged in, you land on the main screen with a bottom navigation bar. The tabs shown depend on your account type:



- **Home** Client only — search and browse counsellors.
- **Community** — the shared question & answer board.
- **Sessions** — your active and past one-on-one chats.
- **Appointments** — your booked, pending and completed appointments.

At the top-right of every main screen, tap your **profile avatar** to open a menu with **Profile** (view/edit your details) and **Logout**.

EXITING THE APP

Pressing the device back button from the main screen shows an "Exit App?" confirmation so you don't accidentally close the app mid-session.

The Home tab is your starting point for finding the right counsellor.

Search

Tap the search bar and type a name or keyword. Results update as you type; tap the ✕ icon to clear your search and return to browsing.

Browse by Category

Swipe through the category carousel to filter by specialisation, including:

- Psychologist
- Marriage Counsellor
- Students' Counsellor
- Career Counsellor
- Family Counsellor
- Addiction Counsellor
- Mental Health Counsellor
- Grief Counsellor
- Rehabilitation Counsellor
- Guidance Counsellor
- Child Counsellor

Top Rated

The **Rated** section shows counsellors sorted by their average client rating, so you can quickly spot highly-recommended professionals.

Quote of the Day

A rotating motivational quote appears on the Home tab — a small daily encouragement while you browse.

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Viewing a Counsellor's Profile

Details, ratings, and how to reach out

Tap any counsellor card to open their full profile, which shows:

- Profile photo, specialisation and star **rating**
- Full name, **email** (tap to send a mail) and **phone number** (tap to call)
- Address and a short **About** section

From this screen you have two ways to connect:

Start Session

chat now

- 1 Tap **Start Session**.
- 2 Choose a **topic** for the session (e.g. Marriage, Career, Mental Health, Grief).
- 3 Tap **Start Session** again to send the request — it opens as a **Pending** session until the counsellor accepts.

If you already have an open session with this counsellor, the button instead reads **Open Session**, taking you straight back into the existing conversation.

Book Appointment

schedule for later

- 1 Tap **Book Appoint.**
- 2 Choose a **date** and **time**.
- 3 Tap **Book** to send the request to the counsellor.

ONE REQUEST AT A TIME

While you have a pending appointment with a counsellor, the button shows "Pending Appoint." instead of letting you book a second one.

8 Counselling Sessions (Chat)

Your private, one-on-one conversation with a counsellor

The **Sessions** tab lists every conversation you're part of. Each session shows the other person's name, photo and live **Online/Offline** status.

Session status

Status	Meaning
Pending	Request sent — waiting for the counsellor to accept before chat is enabled.
Active	The chat is open; both people can send messages.
Ended	The conversation is closed and read-only.

Sending messages

While a session is **Active**, use the message bar at the bottom to:

- Type and send a **text** message.
- Tap the **image icon** to attach a photo from your **Camera** or **Gallery** — you'll see a preview before it sends.
- Tap the **microphone icon** to record and send a short **voice note**.

Messages you haven't yet read are automatically marked as read as soon as you open the session.

Ending a session

1 Inside an active session, tap the **:** menu at the top right.

2 Choose **End Session**, then confirm.

This action is final and cannot be undone — the session moves to Ended and becomes read-only.

Reporting a counsellor

From the same **:** menu, choose **Report Counsellor** if you experience inappropriate behaviour or feel unsafe. Report responsibly and factually.

Booking & Managing Appointments

Scheduled meetings between you and a counsellor

The **Appointments** tab lists everything you've booked or received, with a search bar at the top to quickly find one. Tap an appointment card to open the available actions for it.

Appointment status

Status	Meaning
Pending	Booked, awaiting the counsellor's response.
Accepted	The counsellor has confirmed the date and time.
Ended	The appointment has taken place and is closed.
Cancelled	Either party cancelled the booking.

What each side can do

As a Client

- **Book** a new appointment from a counsellor's profile
- **Reschedule** a Pending appointment to a new date/time
- **Cancel** an appointment at any time before it ends

As a Counsellor

- **Accept** a Pending appointment request
- **End** an Accepted appointment once it's complete
- **Cancel** an appointment at any time before it ends

- 1 Tap the appointment card to open the action menu.
- 2 Choose the action you want (Accept / Reschedule / Cancel / End).
- 3 Confirm in the dialog that shows the appointment's date and time.

RESCHEDULING

Only appointments that are not yet Ended, Cancelled or Accepted can be rescheduled — pick a new date, then a new time, and confirm.

10 Community — Ask & Answer

A shared space for questions, advice and support

The **Community** tab is a public question board where anyone on the platform — Clients and Counsellors alike — can ask for advice or share guidance.

Asking a question

- 1 Tap **Ask a Question**.
- 2 Choose a **Topic Category** (Marriage, Relationship, Family, Career, Addiction, Mental Health, Grief, Rehabilitation, Guidance, Child).
- 3 Type your **Question** and a short **Description** giving context.
- 4 Optionally tick **Post Anonymously** to hide your name, photo and other details from other users.
- 5 Tap **Post Question**.

Browsing & searching

Use the search bar at the top of the Community tab to find questions by keyword. Tap any question card to open it and read its full description.

Commenting

- 1 Open a question and scroll to the **Comments** section.
- 2 Type your response in the box at the bottom (optionally tick **Post as Anonymous**).
- 3 Tap the **send** icon to post your comment.

You can **edit** or **delete** your own comments at any time via the **:** menu on that comment.

ANONYMOUS POSTING

Anonymous questions and comments show as "Anonymous" with a generic avatar to everyone else — your identity is not revealed anywhere on the community board.

Your Profile & Account Settings

Keeping your details up to date

- 1 Tap your **avatar** in the top-right corner of any main screen.
- 2 Select **Profile** from the menu.
- 3 On the **View** tab, review your current details; switch to the **Edit** tab to make changes.
- 4 Update your **photo, name, phone, address, city, region, about section** or **date of birth** as needed, then save.

Logging out

- 1 Tap your **avatar** in the top-right corner.
- 2 Select **Logout**.

Logging out marks you as offline to other users and returns you to the welcome screen.

ONLINE STATUS

Your Online/Offline status is visible to anyone you're chatting with in a session, and updates automatically when you open or close the app.

12 Safety, Privacy & Etiquette

Getting the most out of a respectful, supportive space

- **Be honest and specific** when describing what's on your mind — it helps your counsellor help you.
- **Respect confidentiality.** Sessions are private between you and your counsellor; do not share screenshots of a conversation without consent.
- **Use anonymity thoughtfully** in the Community — it protects your privacy, but stay respectful and constructive regardless.
- **Verify credentials.** Counsellor profiles display their specialisation and rating to help you choose someone suited to your needs.
- **Report concerns promptly** using the Report Counsellor option in a session if something feels wrong.
- **This is not an emergency service.** If you or someone else is in immediate danger, please contact local emergency services right away.

13 Frequently Asked Questions

Quick answers to common questions

Q. Can I switch from a Client account to a Counsellor account?

A. No — the account type you choose during sign-up cannot be changed. You would need to create a separate account for the other role.

Q. Why can't I see a Home tab?

A. The Home/search tab is only shown to Client accounts. Counsellor accounts open directly into the Community tab, since counsellors are found by clients rather than the other way around.

Q. What happens if I close the app during a session?

A. Nothing is lost — your session and its messages are saved. Reopen the app, go to Sessions, and tap the conversation to continue.

Q. Can I have more than one active session with the same counsellor?

A. No. If an open session already exists, the "Start Session" button becomes "Open Session" and takes you back into the existing conversation instead.

Q. Can I book more than one appointment with the same counsellor at once?

A. Not while one is already pending — the button will show "Pending Appoint." until that request is resolved.

Q. Is my Community post really anonymous?

A. Yes. When "Post Anonymously" is ticked, your name, photo and profile link are hidden from every other user viewing the question or comment.

Q. How do I know if a counsellor is currently available?

A. Inside a session, an Online/Offline label next to their name shows their live status.

14 Getting Help

When you need more support than this guide covers

If you run into a problem that isn't covered here:

- Use **Report Counsellor** inside a session for concerns about a specific counsellor.
 - Post in the **Community** for general guidance from peers and counsellors.
 - Reach out to your app administrator or support contact for account or technical issues.
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Thank you for using the platform. We hope this guide helps you get the most out of it.